

Big Large Brother — LLM-Powered Agents System for Supporting Masters in RPGs

The tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) market has long been one of the most prolific and resilient segments of the gaming industry, with a large and globally distributed player base and a steadily growing market. This growth has been further accelerated by digital technologies. During the COVID era, a community traditionally centered around in-person sessions was forced to migrate toward digital platforms specifically designed to support remote tabletop play. More recently, virtual reality has emerged as a promising avenue to restore a more immersive and embodied gameplay experience, while preserving the advantages of remote participation. At this point, it is no longer a question of *whether* players will be able to inhabit god-like perspectives over their characters in digital and virtual environments, but rather *when* this transition will fully materialize.

Alongside these technological shifts, the advent of large language models (LLMs) has the potential to address one of the long-standing needs of tabletop RPG game masters (GMs): effective knowledge organization. Designing and running a campaign is an inherently creative process that thrives on a degree of controlled chaos; nevertheless, GMs have consistently expressed the desire for digital support capable of capturing, structuring, and preserving campaign knowledge. Recording sessions, extracting structured summaries, maintaining consultable campaign wikis, and retaining narrative coherence and epic continuity across sessions remain aspirational goals for many players.

LLMs offer a concrete opportunity to turn this vision into reality. The goal of this thesis proposal is to design and develop a multi-agent LLM-based system that acts as an intelligent companion for tabletop RPG game masters. Starting from a requirements engineering phase grounded in direct interaction with GMs, the thesis will focus on the development of a well-structured prototype designed to support iterative refinement and long-term evolution. The proposed solution will be empirically validated through user-centered evaluations, assessing its usefulness, usability, and impact on the game mastering experience.

References:

https://consensus.app/search/llm-solutions-for-game-masters/TUA6WlXwR5uZSdNjjLN_2A/?utm_source=share&utm_medium=clipboard

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